The Bank Beneath the Leaves

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 5, Episode 8

The keeper opened the inlet cover. Leaves lay pressed against a displaced screen. Nib fetched a brush large enough for the whole bank. Lark laid the guide beside the small screen and its collecting tray. The trouble occupied much less space than Nib's proposed sweeping route.

“The whole bank needs a brush,” Nib proposed. “This small screen needs room,” Lark replied thoughtfully.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **all**

“In bank and sink, nk represents /ng/ followed closely by /k/,” Lark modeled clearly. “Compare ring, with its single ng sound, and bank, with the added ending. Read bank, sink, and pink without inserting a vowel inside that final group.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try bank, sink, pink. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read bank on the access note,” Lark invited gently. “Which small part does its diagram actually ask the keeper to clear?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The bank is wet. A leaf is on the screen.**

“Where is the leaf?” Lark asked gently. “Does the first sentence explain the clock timing?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

The keeper lifted the leaf mat into a collecting tray and reseated the screen. Nib carried the tray away from the channel. Flow visibly improved. Then the clock chimed at the wrong point again. Lark kept both results: the inlet repair helped water flow, and the timing problem still needed explaining.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write bank beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal marked the screen repair complete without marking the whole garden fixed. The keeper's work log held earlier completed tasks and a different page for what still needed checking.